Remember, remember the 5th of November!

Nivel Básico A2 · Culture · Bonfire Night and Guy Fawkes

1 Bonfire Night words

Match the pictures (1–10) with the words (a–j).












a a barrel	d the king	g the guy	j a toffee apple
b a bonfire	e fireworks	h the Houses of Parliament	
c the cellar	f a lantern	i a sparkler	

1 ___ 2 ___ 3 ___ 4 ___ 5 ___ 6 ___ 7 ___ 8 ___ 9 ___ 10 ___

2 Read: Bonfire Night

Every year on 5 November, people in the UK go outside in the cold and the dark. They light big bonfires and watch fireworks in parks and gardens. Children write their names in the air with sparklers. People eat toffee apples, sausages and jacket potatoes, and drink hot chocolate.

Why? Because of a famous plot in 1605. A group of men wanted to kill King James I. They put 36 barrels of gunpowder in a cellar under the Houses of Parliament in London. One of the men was Guy Fawkes, from York. He was an expert with gunpowder. He was a soldier for Spain for many years, and there he used the name "Guido".

But someone wrote a letter to a friend in Parliament... On the night of 4 November, guards found Guy Fawkes in the cellar with the gunpowder. The plot failed and the king was safe. That night, people in London lit bonfires to celebrate.

Today, some families still make a "guy" – a figure with old clothes and newspaper – and put it on the bonfire. The biggest celebration is in Lewes, a small town in the south of England.

Glossary: *plot = conspiración · kill = matar · soldier = soldado · guards = guardias · failed = fracasó · safe = a salvo · lit (light) = encendieron*

A True or false? Correct the false sentences.

1 Bonfire Night is in October. T / F _____

2 Guy Fawkes was from London. T / F _____

3 The gunpowder was in a cellar under Parliament. T / F _____

4 Guy Fawkes was a soldier for France. T / F _____

5 The plot was successful. T / F _____

6 People still make a "guy" today. T / F _____

Example: *No, it's not in October. It's in November. / It's in November, not October!*

B Find in the text: a year _____ · a number _____ · two cities _____ , _____ · a town _____ · three things to eat _____ , _____ , _____

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3 Listen: Lucía in York

Lucía is a Spanish student in York. Her friend Emma calls her. Listen and complete the poster.

BONFIRE NIGHT IN THE PARK · Tonight!	
Date	_____ November
Bonfire	at _____
Fireworks	at _____
Tickets	£ _____ (children: _____)
Wear	a hat, a _____, _____ and boots
Food	toffee apples, _____ and parkin
Meet	at the park _____

Listen again. Answer the questions.

1 Is 5 November a holiday in the UK? _____

2 What is parkin? _____

3 Is Guy Fawkes a footballer? _____

4 What is the connection between Guy Fawkes and Spain? _____

Real English: Watch the British Council video Word on the Street: Bonfire Night. Write three things you see.

4 The chant: Remember, remember

British children learn this old rhyme. Listen, clap and complete with the words in the box.

forgot · November · plot · remember

Remember, _____ the fifth of _____,
Gunpowder, treason and _____.
I see no reason why gunpowder treason
Should ever be _____.

Glossary: *treason = traición · I see no reason why... = no veo por qué... · forgot = forgotten (olvidado), an old form to rhyme with plot*

Say it! Clap on the stressed syllables: re-MEM-ber, re-MEM-ber, the FIFTH of No-VEM-ber... Then say it in two groups: group A line 1, group B line 2...

5 Talk: and in Spain?

In pairs, answer the questions.

1 Are there bonfires in Spain? When? (San Juan, 23 June · Las Fallas, March · San Antón, January...)

2 Do you like fireworks? Why / Why not?

3 Is there a festival with fire in Zamora or in your town?

Useful language: *In Spain we have bonfires on... · In my town there is... · I love / I don't like fireworks because they're...*

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